

CORPORATE WELLBEING PROPOSAL

Counselling, Connection & Workplace Wellbeing

A flexible employee wellbeing partnership combining confidential one-to-one counselling with practical group sessions and workplace workshops.

For small and growing organisations looking to support people, strengthen teams and build healthier ways of working.

Michael Kaplan
ASCHP-registered Wellness Counsellor

Support the person. Strengthen the workplace.

Workplace wellbeing is not only about what happens when somebody reaches breaking point.

Stress, grief, relationship difficulties, anxiety, conflict and life transitions do not stay neatly outside the office. When people are struggling, concentration, motivation, communication and relationships at work can all be affected.

Sangham offers employees a confidential place to work through what is happening before difficulties become more entrenched. The employer funds access; the employee remains the counselling client.

Alongside individual support, organisations can add carefully designed group sessions and workshops focused on communication, stress, emotional awareness, conflict, trust and healthier team functioning.

The aim is not simply to help people cope. It is to create more capacity for reflection, communication and constructive action.

Designed for real workplaces. The partnership can begin simply with a pool of counselling sessions and expand where useful into team development, facilitated conversations or focused wellbeing workshops.

Simple access. Clear boundaries. Support that can grow with the need.

1

Company funds access

A company purchases an agreed allocation of counselling sessions for eligible employees.

2

Employees book directly

Employees contact Sangham directly so that access remains private, simple and independent of management.

3

Counselling stays confidential

Session content is not reported back to the employer except with consent or where a recognised safety or legal exception applies.

4

Add organisational support

Workshops, group sessions and facilitated conversations can be added where the need is organisational rather than individual.

Not a full EAP

This is an independent counselling and workplace wellbeing service, not a 24-hour employee assistance programme or emergency response service.

Not performance management

Counselling is not used to judge quotas, discipline employees or provide management with private clinical information.

Not clinical diagnosis

Where psychiatric diagnosis, specialised treatment, emergency care or formal assessment is required, referral is made to an appropriate professional.

The employer can support access without becoming part of the counselling room.

A private place to work through what is getting in the way

Employees can use sessions for difficulties affecting their wellbeing, relationships or functioning.

Common areas of work include stress, emotional strain, anxiety, grief, relationship difficulties, life transitions, recurring patterns, motivation and interpersonal challenges.

- 60-minute sessions
- Online during weekday working hours
- Newlands: selected weekday evenings
- Saturday morning availability

Employees do not need to justify their reason for attending to management. Where an employee approaches counselling because work performance is under strain, the counselling process still remains separate from the employer's performance-management process.

The work is supportive and reflective rather than diagnostic. It helps people understand what is happening, identify patterns, consider choices and develop healthier ways of responding.

If the presenting concern suggests that a psychologist, psychiatrist, medical practitioner, emergency service or other specialist is more appropriate, the employee will be supported with referral. Where helpful, supportive counselling may continue alongside specialist care.

WHEN WORK IS PART OF THE PROBLEM

Sessions can explicitly explore workplace stress, difficult conversations, boundaries, motivation, conflict and adjustment. The counsellor can help the employee think through constructive next steps without becoming an evaluator for management.

The employee is the client. The company enables access to support.

When the challenge belongs to the team, work with the team

Not every workplace difficulty is best handled through private counselling. Some patterns need a shared conversation.

Facilitated sessions can help colleagues address tension, rebuild communication and clarify what needs to change.

These sessions are kept distinct from an employee's private counselling.

Participation, purpose, confidentiality and who will receive any feedback are agreed in advance so that nobody is surprised by the role of the facilitator.

POSSIBLE FOCUS AREAS

- Communication & difficult conversations
- Interpersonal conflict
- Trust & psychological safety
- Stress & burnout awareness

Company-wide workshops can also be used proactively, before a problem becomes a crisis.

Workplace communication

listening, feedback and repair

Stress & self-regulation

recognising overload earlier

Connection & team culture

healthier ways of relating

Change & transition

navigating uncertainty together

Workshops combine guided discussion, reflection, practical exercises and usable psychological or mindfulness-based tools. They are adapted to the team's real context rather than delivered as generic motivational talks.

A healthier workplace is not one without tension. It is one with more capacity to notice, communicate and repair.

Start simple. Add depth where it is useful.

A small organisation can begin with a counselling allocation and add organisational work as needed.

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| 01 | Individual session
R850 · 60 minutes · online or in person where available |
| 02 | 5-session package
R3,400 total · R680 per session |
| 03 | Corporate counselling pool
From 5 prepaid sessions · R680 per session · non-refundable · valid for 12 months |
| 04 | Focused facilitated session
From R1,750 · 60–90 minutes · small team / workplace issue |
| 05 | 3-hour workplace workshop
R5,500 · up to 20 participants · preparation included |
| 06 | Half-day workshop
R7,500 · up to 20 participants · approximately 4 hours |

OPTIONAL

Larger groups & custom programmes

Quoted separately where participant numbers, preparation, travel, multiple facilitators or custom materials materially change the scope.

OPTIONAL

Retainer / monthly allocation

For organisations wanting a predictable monthly pool of counselling plus agreed check-ins or workshops, a tailored retainer can be structured.

Individual support and healthier collective functioning

No ethical provider can promise a productivity outcome from counselling. The aim is to strengthen human capacities that can support wellbeing and better functioning at work.

Earlier support

A low-friction route to support before stress or personal difficulty becomes more entrenched.

Healthier communication

More capacity to name concerns, listen, set boundaries and approach difficult conversations constructively.

Self-regulation

Practical ways to recognise overload, pause and respond with greater awareness.

Connection

A workplace culture in which asking for help and relating with humanity become more normal.

More reflective choices

Space to understand patterns and consider healthier responses without removing personal responsibility.

Stronger team culture

Shared sessions can strengthen empathy, mutual support, honest communication and the ability to repair after tension.

Wellbeing support can contribute to better functioning. It should never become a covert tool for surveillance or discipline.

Useful information for the employer, without turning counselling into surveillance

Default position



An employer may know how many sessions have been funded or used, and can receive carefully aggregated observations where numbers are large enough to protect identity. The employer does not automatically receive diagnoses, session notes, personal histories or opinions about an employee's character or performance.

For small teams, even apparently anonymous thematic reporting can identify people. In those settings, reporting should stay especially minimal.

What if management refers someone?

Management can encourage or formally refer an employee to seek support, but performance expectations should remain a management responsibility. If feedback is requested, the employee should know exactly what may be shared before counselling begins and provide specific written consent where appropriate.

What can responsibly be shared?

Generally appropriate:

- total sessions used / remaining
- service uptake at aggregate level
- agreed attendance confirmation where genuinely necessary and consented to
- broad non-identifying organisational themes where anonymity is realistic
- recommendations for workshops, manager training or systemic support

Not ordinarily appropriate:

- counselling notes or detailed session content
- diagnosis or psychiatric opinion
- whether the employee is "telling the truth"
- performance, disciplinary or fitness-for-duty conclusions

SEPARATE ROLES WHERE NEEDED

If the organisation needs mediation, formal assessment or a report for an employment decision, that role may need to be handled separately from the employee's private counselling relationship.

08 · FACILITATOR

Michael Kaplan

ASCHP-registered Wellness Counsellor, group facilitator and founder of Sangham.

Michael has more than a decade of experience working with boys and young men through mentoring, group facilitation and counselling, including many years within the Boys to Men community in Cape Town.

His work combines relational counselling, group process and long-term experience with mindfulness and contemplative practice.

Within organisations, the emphasis is on creating psychologically safe spaces in which people can reflect honestly while keeping the boundary between employee support and management decision-making clear.

Where a need sits outside his professional scope, Michael refers to psychologists, psychiatrists, medical practitioners, mediators or other appropriate specialists rather than stretching the service beyond its proper role.

A partnership begins with a short conversation.

We clarify workforce size, location, expected utilisation, online / in-person needs, referral pathways, confidentiality, reporting and any team-level priorities before confirming the final service agreement.

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